



Thailand's electronics sector attracts investments worth \$1.8 billion

In the first six months of 2021, the electrical appliances and electronics (E&E) industry attracted the most investment among Thailand's target sectors with 77 projects worth 61 billion baht (\$1.8 billion), a value 136% higher than in the year earlier period. E&E represented 15.8% of the combined value of investments pledged from January to June during that period. The strength of Thailand's supply chain is reflected in its exports of electronic components and equipment, the country's top export category, which reached \$31 billion in 2020.



Representational image

British consortium formed to develop solid-state EV batteries

A group of seven British organisations including battery materials firm Johnson Matthey, start-up Britishvolt, and Oxford University said that they had formed a consortium to develop solid-state batteries for electric vehicles. Britishvolt plans to build a battery factory in northern England that will go into operation in 2023. The plant will be built in three phases and the last of these would be due for completion by 2027. It aims to produce solid-state batteries.

Electronics boom makes tin prices create new record

The prices of tin have made a new record. Tin prices are rising as high as \$34,000 a tonne due to a boom in consumer electronics. Moreover, supply disruption due to Covid-19 is adding fuel to the fire. The other factor driving this surge in prices of tin could be political unrest in Myanmar. The country had gone through a military coup in February this year. Myanmar is the third biggest producer of tin in the world.

Pakistan exports locally-made smartphones to UAE

Pakistan's Inovi Telecom has begun exporting its locally manufactured smartphones to the UAE with the shipments tagged as 'Manufactured in Pakistan.' However, the local manufacturers of mobile phone sets have stressed the need for an export supportive policy, allowing Pakistan to beat competitors in the Middle East region. While mass markets of Gulf countries was their primary target, the ordinary citizens of Iraq, Iran, and Afghanistan too preferred mobile sets up to \$100 each.

NVIDIA's Jensen Huang to receive Robert N. Noyce Award

The Semiconductor Industry Association (SIA) has announced Jensen Huang, founder CEO of NVIDIA, as the 2021 recipient of the industry's highest honour, the Robert N. Noyce Award. Huang founded NVIDIA in 1993 and has served since its inception as CEO and a member of the board of directors. Starting out in 3D graphics, NVIDIA helped build the gaming market into the world's largest entertainment industry. More recently, NVIDIA ignited modern AI, the next era of computing, with the GPU acting as the brain of computers, robots, and self-driving cars.

Ashok Leyland to invest \$200 million for producing EVs through its subsidiary in UK

Ashok Leyland will invest up to \$200 million in producing electric vehicles through its UK based subsidiary Switch Mobility in the next few years. Switch Mobility will play in the commercial EV space globally for Ashok Leyland's parent Hinduja Group through

next-generation electric bus and light commercial vehicles. The arm will also launch an electric light commercial vehicle later this year in India.

Google planning huge R&D facility in Silicon Valley

Tech giant Google is planning to build a campus that will house a huge hardware hub in Silicon Valley. The campus called 'Midpoint' will have 20% office space and 80% space focused on manufacturing devices, storage,

distribution, and other purposes. Google has spent more than \$389 million to buy land in northern San Jose, California for the five-building hardware research and development centre.

Marvell Technology acquires Innovium in all-stock transaction

American chip company Marvell Technology has announced that it is buying out cloud and data centres networking solutions provider Innovium in an all-stock transaction. Under the terms of the definitive agreement, Innovium shareholders will receive \$1.1 billion in consideration consisting of approximately 19.05 million shares of Marvell Common Stock that will be issued in aggregate in exchange for all outstanding equity of Innovium. Marvell has an extensive portfolio of Ethernet switch semiconductor solutions.

Foxconn buys \$90.8 million wafer plant from Macronix

Macronix International has announced the signing of an asset transaction agreement for the sale of Macronix's 15cm (6-inch) wafer fab and equipment in Hsinchu Science Park to Foxconn for NT\$2.52 billion (about \$90.8 million). In addition to manufacturing SiC power MOSFET, Foxconn confirmed that it will also manufacture silicon wafer products such as MEMS to achieve Foxconn's strategic goals on development of semiconductors industry, electric vehicles, and digital health.

Qualcomm offers to acquire Veoneer for \$37 per share in cash

Qualcomm Incorporated announced it has submitted an offer to acquire Veoneer for \$37 per share in an all-cash transaction. The offer has been approved by Qualcomm's board of directors. "The proposed acquisition will bring together our industry-leading automotive solutions with Veoneer's assisted driving assets to deliver a competitive and open ADAS platform to automakers and Tier 1 suppliers at scale," noted Cristiano Amon, president and CEO of Qualcomm.

LG to spend \$2.8 billion to expand medium and small size OLED display production

South Korean conglomerate LG Group's LG Display announced that it will invest 3.3 trillion won (about \$2.8 billion) to expand its medium and small-size OLED display production capacity. LG Display's hold on the medium and small-size OLED sector is still nascent, even though it is the world's sole supplier of large-size OLED panels for TVs. Industry observers said the investment is expected to help LG Display to produce 60,000 medium and small-size OLED sheets per month at its plant in Paju, north of Seoul.